



GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church

We seek, we serve, we celebrate.

JUN 2021

June

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Have you heard? We're worshipping in person!

Are you on Facebook?
Join our private Minnehaha Community Page!

About Us:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church is a thriving multi-generational, multicultural Christian community devoted to social justice and personal spiritual growth. The congregation is both mission- and worship-focused. In addition to its worship, education, and social activities, the church supports local mission activities, including a food shelf and a monthly food distribution program. The church also supports a variety of national and international relief, education, and development projects.

A Reconciling Congregation:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church opens our doors to all God's people. We will strive to offer unconditional love and acceptance to all persons, regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history. We work to eliminate prejudice and discriminatory practices within ourselves and within our community. -adopted 2006

Our Mission:

We seek, we serve, we celebrate, we carry our Christian faith into our community and the world. We provide a caring gathering place to worship God and to grow spiritually. -reconfirmed 2011



Worship in June

We are back! We are outside, masked, but we are worshiping together again. And, we are still also worshiping online, finding ways to connect those on the lawn with those in front of screens.

The month of June begins with a big celebration – we will recognize graduates on June 6, and will also be celebrating the baptism of Addy and Henry Kappelman. Then on June 13, we'll have a blessing of bikes and bike helmets.

Throughout the month of June, our scripture readings will come from Paul's letters, and we'll be talking about the myriad of ways Paul negotiated the divides in his culture, taking clues from the Bible on how we might begin to negotiate the divides in our culture.

We look forward to seeing you in person on the lawn, or "seeing you" virtually as you worship with us online.

June 6	"Letters Across the Divide: Do Not Lose Heart"	<i>II Corinthians 4:13-5:1</i>
June 13	"Letters Across the Divide: Seeing Christ Even In You"	<i>II Corinthians 5:14-17</i>
June 20	"Letters Across the Divide: Removing the Obstacles"	<i>II Corinthians 6:1-13</i>
June 27	"Letters Across the Divide: Talking Money"	<i>II Corinthians 8:7-15</i>





JUNE

Summer is upon us, and there is a lot to celebrate, and still a lot of uncertainty as we continue to plan. We are grateful for all the vaccinations that have been given, *and* know that we have a lot further to go - especially as we consider programming for children & youth at Minnehaha. The Covid Task Force, Children's Council and Youth Council will all continue to follow guidelines and to evaluate and reevaluate what is the best way to be in community together. At this point, we won't have as much on zoom (Sunday School, for instance, is on summer break), and will focus on offering outdoor, masked activities. We do anticipate needing to have some online programming again in the fall, as we wait for all to be able to receive vaccinations.

If you have any concerns and/or questions, please contact me at education@minnehaha.org, and I will do my best to answer (or help you find answers).

Thanks for being a part of the Minnehaha community!
Jenia Strom, Director of Children, Youth, & Family Ministries

DREAMING OF AUTUMN

While we are not sure yet what autumn will look like for Faith Formation, we want to be sure that we're ready for any possibility - which includes spending time in person in the Minnehaha building.

This means that we'll be needing to get the classrooms set - they were left quite suddenly back in March 2020, and so there's lots to do to clean up, brighten up and recreate welcoming spaces for children & youth to return to. In the next month, we'll be reaching out to folks asking for help - please consider what role you might be able to play to help us be ready!



FAMILY FUN EVENTS

Throughout the summer, Children's Council will be hosting a series of Family Fun Events. These are aimed at preschoolers through fifth graders and their families. We'll be offering them at a variety of times, trying to catch as many people and interests as possible - always with the goal of getting to spend time together as a community. We hope that you'll join us when you can, and if you have an interest/skill you'd like to share with us at one of these events, or would like to help host, please let us know!

HAVE YOU SIGNED UP FOR OUR SUMMER CAMPS?

We're hard at work getting set for our Intergenerational Vacation Bible School (July 18-21st, evenings), and our Music and Drama Camp (July 26th-30th).

These will be outdoor events, with masks required.

We hope you can join us! More information is available throughout this newsletter and on our website.



MINNEHAHA YOUTH

**FOR YOUTH WHO'VE FINISHED
5TH THROUGH 12TH GRADE**

**SUMMER TUESDAY NIGHTS
STARTING JUNE 15TH
FROM 6–7:30PM**



**BIKE RIDES
ULTIMATE FRISBEE
KICK BALL
& MORE**

**Each week's activity will
be announced
beforehand via email, so
be sure you're on our
mailing list.**

QUESTIONS?

**Contact Jenia Strom at
education@minnehaha.org
or Paul & Beth Minehart at
pbpminehart@gmail.com**





Minnehaha Youth Summer Kick-off

for youth entering 6th-12th grade

Sunday, June 6th

3-5pm

Meet at Lake Hiawatha

We're canoeing!

RSVP required so we can
be sure we're set for
everyone.

Masks & physical
distancing required.



JOIN US THIS SUMMER:

MINNEHAHA FAMILY CAMPING TRIP

WHEN: AUGUST 20-22

WHERE: BAKER PARK RESERVE
ON LAKE INDEPENDENCE
(JUST A 40 MINUTE DRIVE
FROM SOUTH MINNEAPOLIS)

COST: \$53.23/FAMILY FOR TWO NIGHTS

RSVP TO BETH MINEHART AT
952.232.7711

Blessing of Bikes (and helmets)

June 13 will be a special service to bless bikes and bike helmets. Ride your bike to church, or at least bring your bike helmet to be blessed.

Annual Meeting for Elected Positions

On Tuesday, June 1, we'll be holding a Charge Conference. That's the very specific (and required) United Methodist term for a meeting that is normally Church Council, but includes everyone. We'll meet on zoom at 6:30 (the link has been in your weekly enews; contact becky@minnehaha.org if you need it sent to you), and the agenda will include the approval of our new list of committee members, as well as voting on the continuation of Sarah Schroerlucke as a candidate for ministry. Anyone can attend, and any member of the church is eligible to vote. Let Becky know if you have any questions.



MINNEHAHA UMC INVITES YOU TO

Celebrate Creation: an Intergenerational VBS

Come together as families for activities, music, stories and more that help us celebrate and consider how we care for creation

**Sunday, July 18 from 3-4:30PM &
Monday, July 19, Tuesday, July 20, &
Wednesday July 21 from 6-7:30pm**

Dinner options will be available at 5:30pm on the 19th-21st

COST PER FAMILY \$10

All materials will also be available online. Come in person for what you can! We will be outside and following Covid-precautions.



REGISTER at www.minnehaha.org





**United
Methodist
Women**

United Methodist Women

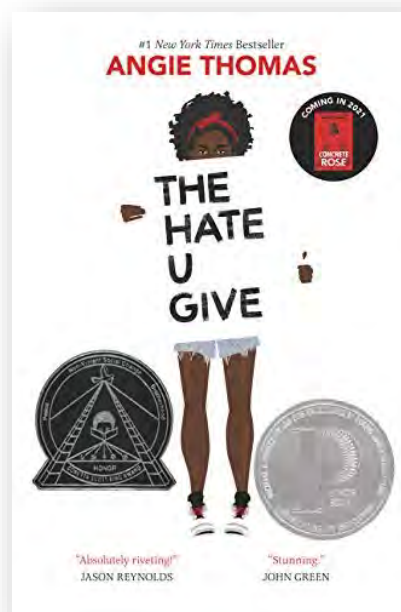
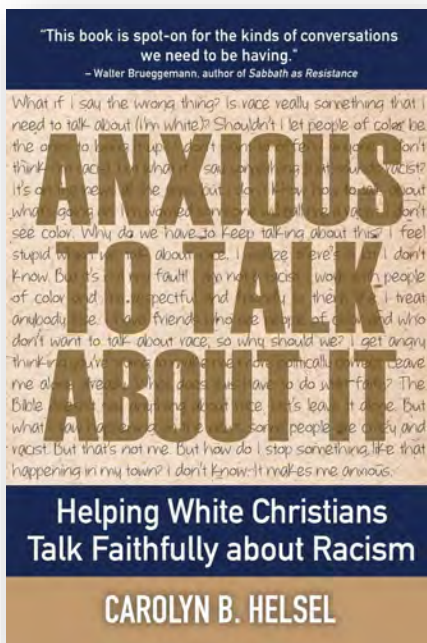
Spring really has sprung with wonderful blossoms and lessening of Covid strictures, come on out, Women of MUMC, and celebrate with a Night Out on Minnehaha Parkway, just for fun, just to be with others, just to enjoy. Tuesday, June 8 stop by between 5:30 and 8:00 on my deck at 1610 E. Minnehaha Pkwy. along with being at picnic tables right across the street and next to Minnehaha Creek. I'll provide the beer and wine and you bring snacks to share or not. We're outdoors so, hopefully, masks not required unless you want to wear one. If it rains, my house isn't far away. Get reacquainted with your MUMC friends or make some if you've never yet been in person at church. Questions? Maureen Trepp at 612-387-2520

Another Big Announcement: Hold on to all that rummage you've accumulated over the year and bring it to MUMC on Sunday, Aug. 29 or Sunday Sept. 5 to be sorted and readied for a fall Rummage Sale on Sept. 9-11. Please don't bring it any sooner (no place to store). We'll be selling, hopefully, mostly on the north side of the building with access to the Fellowship Hall, if needed, thru the 50th St. door. No clothing or large furniture and everything should be in working order. The rummage sale will benefit both MUMC and UMW but....you need to help out. There's many opportunities to volunteer to prep for the sale and work at it and buy stuff! We'll begin recruiting you soon or just let Maureen know you want to help that week, Sept. 6-11.

Along with suggestions from our new Racial Justice committee, I recommend some more books from the National UMW Reading Program. If you wish to participate in the program, information and the catalog of all the suggested books is at UMW Reading Program and you can challenge yourself to read a number of the suggestions. Please let me know if we should purchase these for our library.

ANXIOUS TO TALK ABOUT IT: HELPING WHITE CHRISTIANS TALK FAITHFULLY ABOUT RACISM

Talking about race can make us anxious. Professor and pastor Carolyn Helsel draws on her experiences with white congregations to offer tools and practices to explore the anxious feelings that can come up when talking about racism.



THE HATE U GIVE by Angie Thomas. Starr, 16, moves between two worlds: the poor neighborhood where she lives and her fancy suburban prep school. This uneasy balance is shattered when she witnesses the fatal police shooting of her childhood best friend, Khalil.

For the future in the fall: We will begin serving again at Simpson Shelter this fall on Wed., Sept. 29, Wed. Oct. 27 and Mon. Nov. 29. Let me know if you'd like to help.

Far Future: The UMW Assembly, a coming together of UMW from around the world, will be from May 20-22, 2022 in Orlando Fl. It's fun.

See you on June 8! Peace, Maureen Trepp

Minnehaha Music & Drama Camp

When: Monday, July 26 – Friday, July 30th
from 9am – 3pm

Who: Kids who've completed first through eighth grade

Where: Rehearsals outside at Minnehaha UMC
& Performance at Minnehaha Falls Park on Friday evening

Cost: \$100/participant – Includes lunch

We'll work together on all aspects of putting together a musical:
from costumes, and props to acting, singing, and dancing.

This year's show is *Minnehaha Falls: The Musical*
written by our very own Maureen Trepp.

The show explores the history of our little corner of the world. Our
performance will be outdoors at various historic locations nearby
(easy walking throughout Minnehaha Fall Park).

We will be outside as much as possible during this week,
following Covid precautions, and adapting as necessary.

Scholarships are available if necessary.
Register at www.minnehaha.org



Many thanks to those who got our Minnehaha garden planted this spring, and to Bloomington Garden Center for their plant donations. If you'd like to join us the Garden Care Team - helping to water, weed, and tend, please contact Jenia at education@minnehaha.org. All ages are welcome!

Minnehaha Garden Team



JUNE 8 5:30-8:30

Women's Night Out

Ready to get outside and see some of those faces you've been missing? Come to Maureen's deck and space across the street near Minnehaha Creek for a just get together fun time.

1610 E. MINNEHAHA PKWY.

Drop in from 5:30-8:00 pm, beer and wine provided, bring snacks to share. If it rains? My indoors is quite close! Let's celebrate the summer and vaccinations!! Maureen Trepp, 612-387-2520



MinneHarvest

Our free food give-away once a month (on the fourth Saturday of the month) is a source of food relied upon by many, and it happens through volunteers who come each month. Please join us on June 26. You can volunteer anytime between 6:30 and 10:30 a.m. We start setting up at 6:30, unload the trucks starting at 7, serve the food starting around 7:30, and are usually done cleaning up by 10:30. Join us for all or any portion of that time, dress appropriately for the weather, and bring a friend (and a mask)!



Note
from the
pastor



Now It Begins

One of my favorite benedictions, one that I use on Sundays we have communion, goes like this:

And now the service *begins*.

Go forth in the knowledge that we are God's body,
that the hope for a new world is in the blood of our veins,
that the struggle for justice is the beat to which our hearts respond,
and that God's promises are the very stuff of which our bones are made.
Go forth, and praise God from whom all blessings flow.

Amen.



So, here we are. Many of us are vaccinated, the mask mandate for the state has been lifted, things are opening back up, returning to "normal." The science is showing that the vaccines are very effective, and that those of us who are vaccinated are not only pretty well protected from Covid-19, our vaccines help others by making us unable to carry the disease and infect others.

And now the service begins. The pandemic was hard, it was deadly, and we all had to adjust and make decisions constantly about how we would protect ourselves and others. Now, without the rules of the state to guide us, what will we do? We know people are still getting infected. We know not everyone is vaccinated. We know that none of our children under the age of 12 are vaccinated. How do we come back together as a church? The hard decisions are far from over; this pandemic will impact the way we do church, the way we greet each other, the way we treat colds and the flu and everything else going forward.

We created a Covid Task Force to help make these decisions. A rather large group of people, it is not meant to act nimbly, but instead to include representation from as many groups as possible and to act thoughtfully. Some in the group are ready to take their masks off and start singing yesterday! Some in the group are cautiously optimistic about our summer worship plans, but not sure at all when we can safely worship (or gather at all) indoors. This part is hard. It's hard for all of us. To guide us, the Task Force started with our values:

We Are a People Who Do No Harm

We value the health and safety of our congregation, our staff and our visitors, and we understand that it will take flexibility from all to reopen fully.

We Are a People Who Do All the Good We Can

We value inclusion and offer in-person and online options of worship, education and fellowship as we regather with measured thoughtfulness.

We Are a People Who Stay In Love With God

We value love and strive to treat each other with respect, kindness and compassion as we navigate our comfort level for returning to church.

The values in bold come from the United Methodist Church and are called our 3 General Rules.

So, the service begins. The actual worship services begin in-person and outside, but also our service to one another, and to our community. We will make decisions as best we can, keeping in mind what science is showing us and keeping in mind our values. As we navigate the way forward, I invite us to pray regularly, and I invite us to practice as much patience and compassion with one another that we can. After all, we are God's body, and the hope for a new world is in the blood of our veins.

In Joy,

Becky



3701 East 50th Street
Minneapolis, MN 55417

Address Service Requested

Phone: 612/721-6231
Fax: 612/721-7289
E-Mail: becky@minnehaha.org
office@minnehaha.org

6/21



Save the Date

Here are some events coming up this summer. While we know that things can change quickly, we are fairly confident that these events will take place:

- ★ Sunday, July 18 – Wednesday, July 21 –
Modified Vacation Bible School
- ★ Monday, July 26 – Friday, July 30 --
Modified Music & Drama Camp
- ★ Sunday, August 1 at 10:30 a.m. –
Ecumenical worship held at Minnehaha
Falls Park
- ★ Friday, Aug. 20 – Sunday, Aug. 22 –
Minnehaha Camping Weekend at Baker
Lake Park
- ★ Sunday, Aug. 29 – Blessing of the Animals
during worship

